

you were feeling and the external forces that were at play – is there a certain set of conditions that acts as a perfect storm for you in terms of emotional spending? Is there a deeper need that you are repeatedly ignoring and trying to shut out with more and more stuff?



Understanding why we spend with our emotions

During the first wave of the Covid-19 pandemic, the shackles of consumerism seemed to loosen a little. I saw exclamation after exclamation of ‘This is amazing! I don’t need all those things I was buying! I’m saving so much money!’ People seemed to be waking up from the mindless need to make purchase after purchase, and they were feeling better for it. They were seeing the material results pile up in their savings accounts, and they were experiencing the corresponding lightening of their mental load. Worrying less about money, dealing with less buyer’s remorse, was making people feel better.

And then the pandemic wore on, and we got tired. We experienced tough times, our homes became lethal cocktails of undiluted feelings, we missed our friends and families. We were bombarded with bad news, the rising death count ticking us through the time like a metronome, each daily briefing harder to sit through than the last. And we reached out for our usual coping mechanisms, but they weren’t there. We couldn’t go to the gym, or the pool, or our parents’ living room. Lots